ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 59

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First N’Ko Alphabet

ßßß ßßßß ßß ßß

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 27 N’Ko Letters of Bambara (Manding) with English Phonetics

ß ß ß ß ß ß

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First N'Ko Alphabet — ߞ߭ ߘ߯ ߠ ߋ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 59

Text copyright © 2026 Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza. All rights reserved.
No part of this book may be reproduced, stored or shared in any form without written permission from the publisher, except that parents and teachers may copy pages for use with their own children or class.

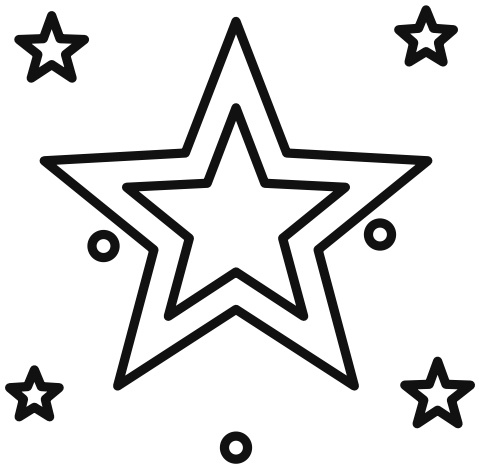
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans NKo, Noto Sans NKo Unjoined, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



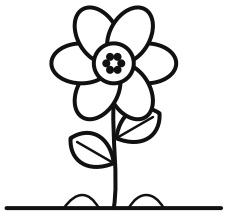
This book belongs to

ɔɔ lɩ ŋ ɔɔ ɔɛɛlv ɣɔ

I started learning Bambara on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 59 is Bambara. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **N'Ko is read from right to left**. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- Every word is shown in **N'Ko**, in the usual **Bambara Latin spelling** (in bold) and in an **easy English sound guide**: ***kɔgɔ*** · *kaw-gaw*.
- In the Latin spelling, **ɛ** says 'e' as in "bed", **ɔ** says 'aw' as in "saw", **ɲ** says 'ny' and **c** says 'ch'.
- **Doubled vowels are long** (*yeelen*); an **n** after a vowel makes it nasal, said a little through the nose (*kɔlɔn*).
- Words follow **Bambara** as spoken in Mali; Maninka and Dyula speakers say many of them a little differently.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Bambara name** written in Bambara (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. Because N'Ko letters **join**, the third box shows the letter at the start, middle and end of a word, plus the Latin letter used for the same sound in Bambara books.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Bambara (Bamanankan) as spoken in Mali.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Bambara! ߓ߁ߟ߭ߊ߬ߣ

bamanankan (bah-mah-nahn-kahn) — the Bambara word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **14 million people** speak Bambara as a first or second language, and many millions more speak its close cousins Maninka, Dyula and Mandinka.[3]

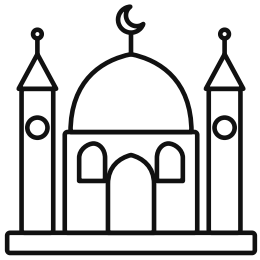
Where?
Bambara is the most widely spoken language of **Mali**. Its Manding cousins are spoken in Guinea, Côte d'Ivoire, Burkina Faso, Senegal, The Gambia and beyond.

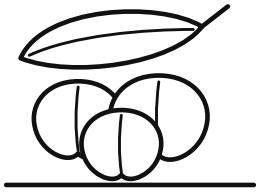
How is it written?
In the **N'Ko** script, from **right to left**, with joined letters. Bambara is also written in Latin letters.

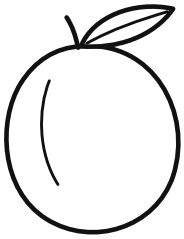
How many letters?
This book teaches **27 letters**: **7 vowels**, the humming **n** and **19 consonants**.

"I say"
N'Ko means "I say" in all the Manding languages. The script was made in **1949** by the teacher Solomana Kanté in Kankan, Guinea, so that Manding could be written in letters of its own.

Numbers too!
N'Ko has its own digits, written from right to left: ߃ ߂ ߁ are 1, 2, 3.







The Bambara Alphabet

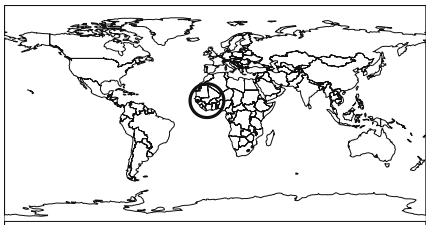
8 vowels — ɲ ƴ ɔ ʋ ʌ Ɣ o ɩ

ʌ ɛ	Ɣ *i*	o *e*	ɩ *a*
ɲ *n*	ƴ ɔ	ɔ *o*	ʋ *u*

19 consonants — ɽ ɓ ɟ ƒ

ŧ *ra*	ɯ *da*	ɳ *ca*	ɽ *ja*	ɓ *ta*	ɟ *pa*	ƒ *ba*
Δ *ma*	ɲ *la*	ɥ *ka*	ơ *fa*	∇ *gba*	ɑ *sa*	ʉ *rra*
		ɸ *ya*	ƌ *wa*	ɥ *ha*	ɳ *na*	ɣ *nya*

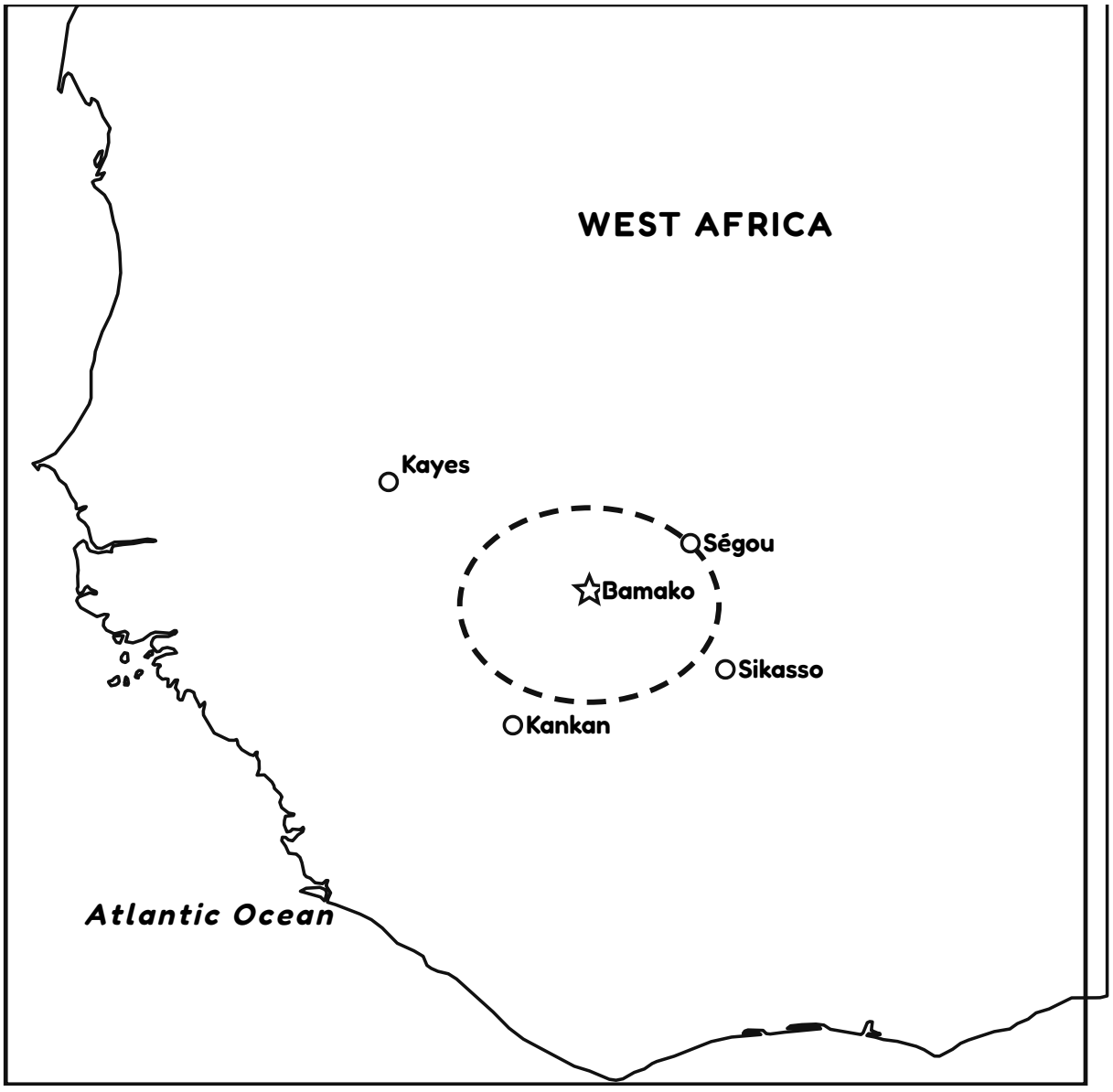
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows West Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Bambara spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Bamako ★ is the capital of Mali. The dashed line goes round the land where Bambara and its Manding cousins are spoken. N'Ko was first written in Kankan.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

The Vowels ߓ ߍ ߌ ߎ ߏ ߊ ߋ ߐ

a · e · i · ɛ · u · o · ɔ · n — the 7 vowels and the humming n

N’Ko is written **from right to left**, like the Qur’an. Open your book at any letter page and start reading on the right!

Seven vowels

Bambara has **seven vowels**, and N’Ko has a letter for each one:

ߍ ߌ ߎ ߏ ߊ ߋ ߐ

a · e · i · ɛ · u · o · ɔ (read from the right)

The humming n

The letter **ߓ** is a humming ‘n’ that makes a syllable all by itself, as in *n-tomi* (tamarind). It also means “I”: ߒ ߞߏ ߓ “I am learning N’Ko”.

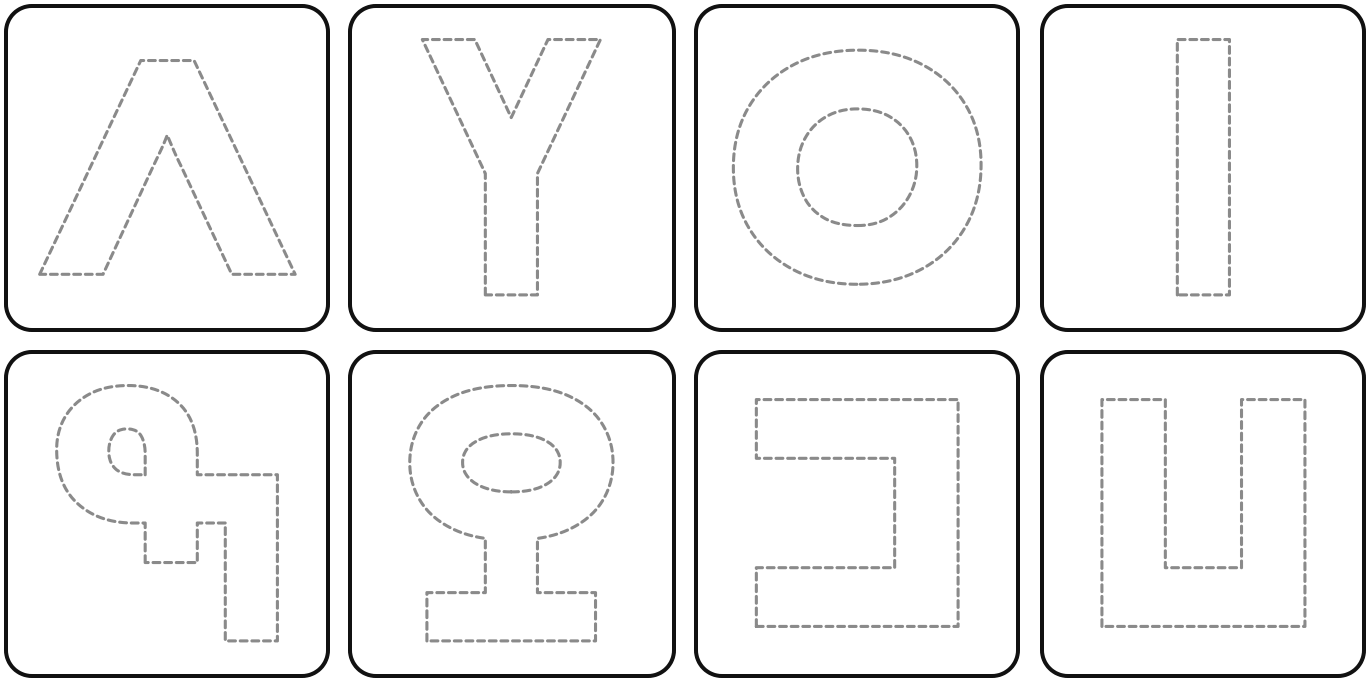
The tune of a word

Bambara words have a **tune** (high and low tones). In books, small marks above the letters show the tune and long vowels. This coloring book shows the letters without those marks, so they are big and clear.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels ㅐ ㅛ ㅋ ㅗ ㅅ ㅑ ㅇ ㅣ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ا

NAME · ᛅᛚᛁᚠ · ƬƆGƆ

ا

a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

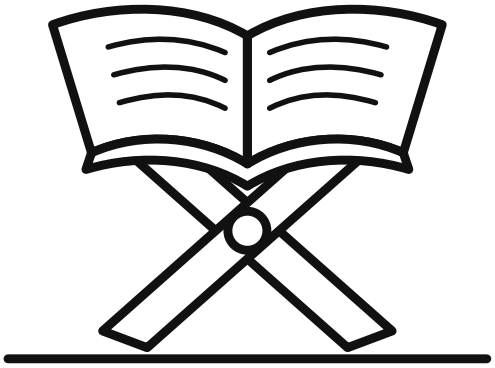
‘a’ as in “father”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ـا ـلا ا

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **a**



ا IS FOR

القرآن

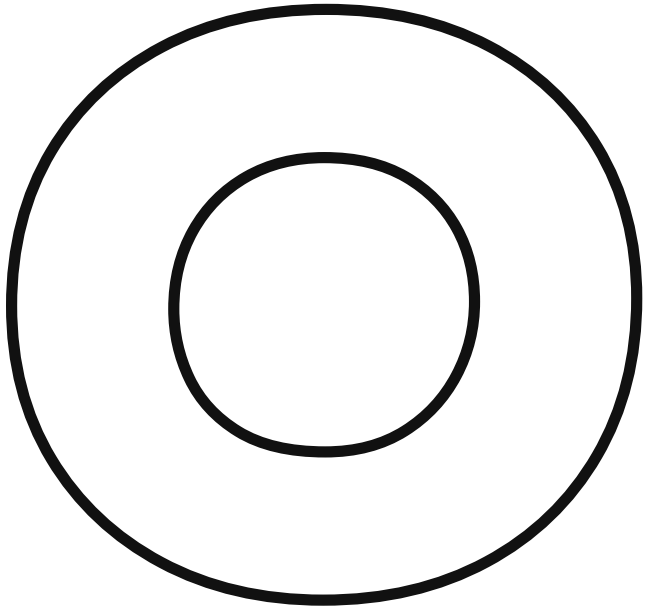
Alikurana · *ah-lee-koo-rah-nah*

the Qur’an

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᛅᚴᚢᚱᛅᚾᛅ · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𖵎𖵒𖵎𖵄 · ƬƆGƆ

o

e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ay’ as in “say”, short and pure

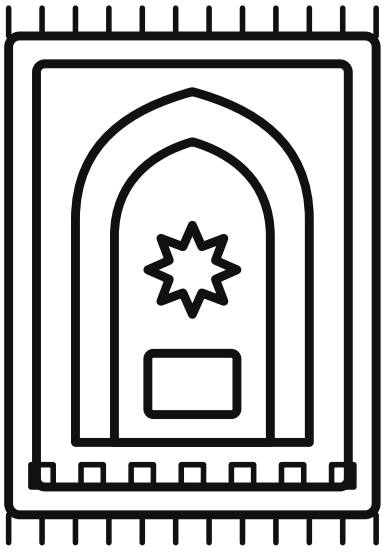
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS



start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **e**

o hardly ever starts a word. Find it in 𖵒𖵎𖵄𖵌!



o **IS FOR**

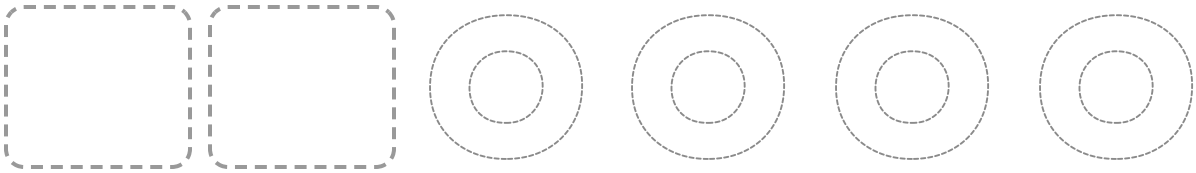


seli · *say-lee*

prayer (salah)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖵍𖵎𖵄 · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Y

NAME · ϘϒϘϧ · ƬƆGƆ

Y

i

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

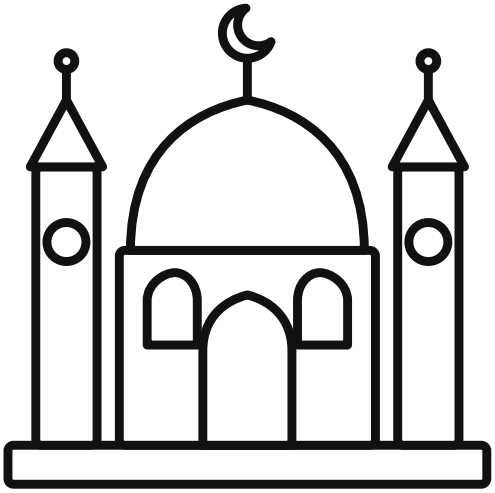
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Y Y Y

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **i**

Find Y inside YtYɑYΔ!



Y **IS FOR**

YtYɑYΔ

misiri · *mee-see-ree*

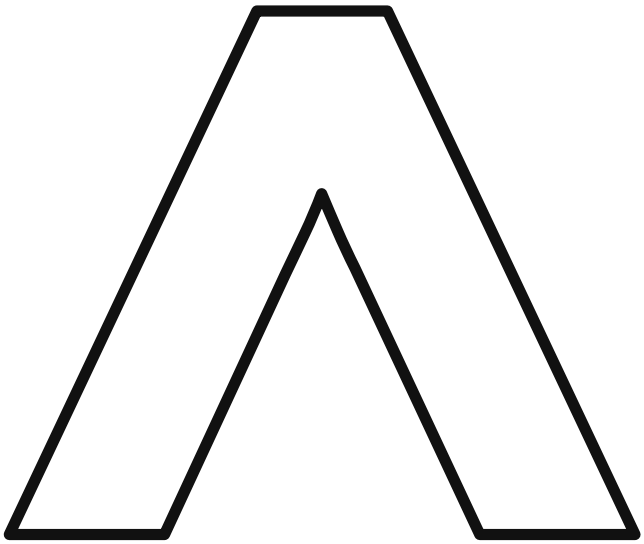
mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ʌƐʌɑ · SƐBƐN

Y Y Y Y

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᛅᚡᛅᚮ · ƎƆGƆ

ʌ

ɛ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

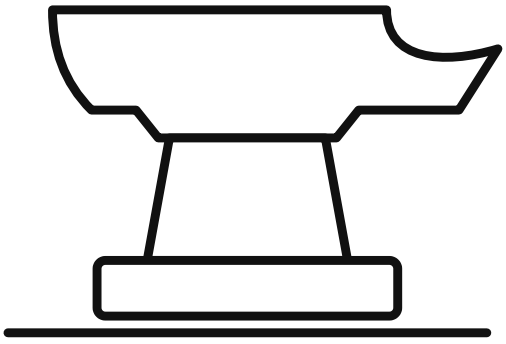
ʌ ʌ ʌ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **ɛ**

Find ʌ inside ʌᛅʌᛘ!

ʌ IS FOR



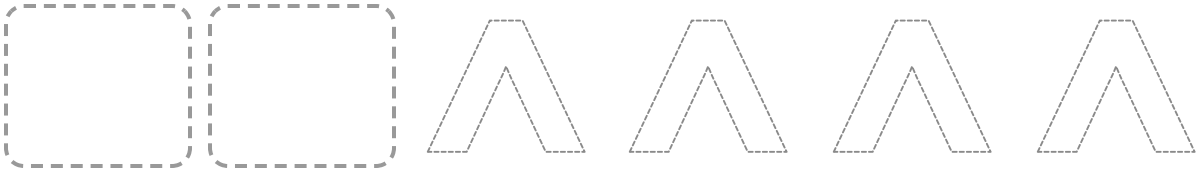
ʌᛅʌᛘ

nɛgɛ · *neh-geh*

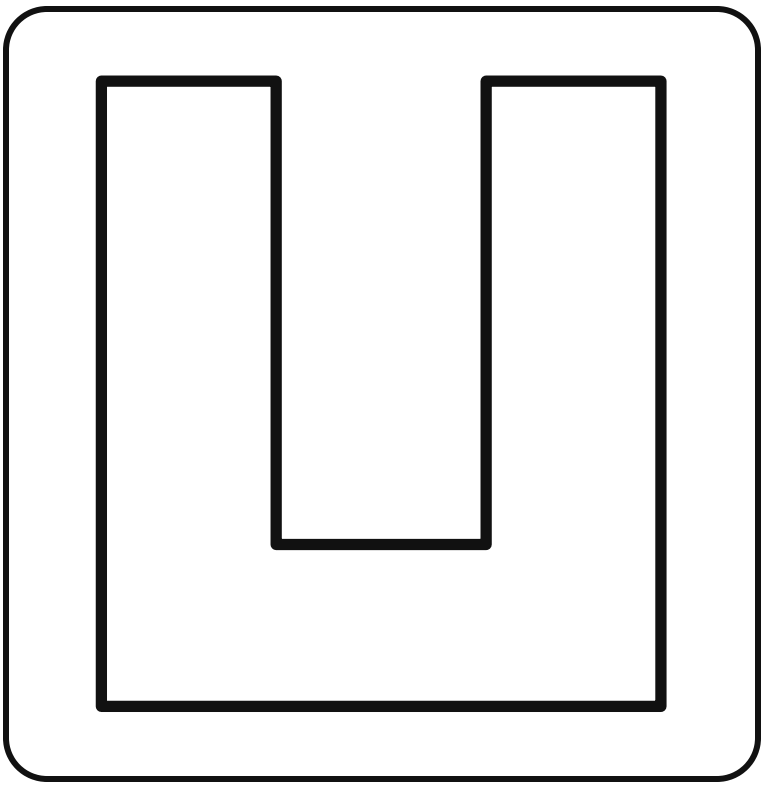
iron, metal

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ʌᛈʌᛘ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᑭᐁᑭᒃ · ƬƆGƆ

ᑌ

u

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

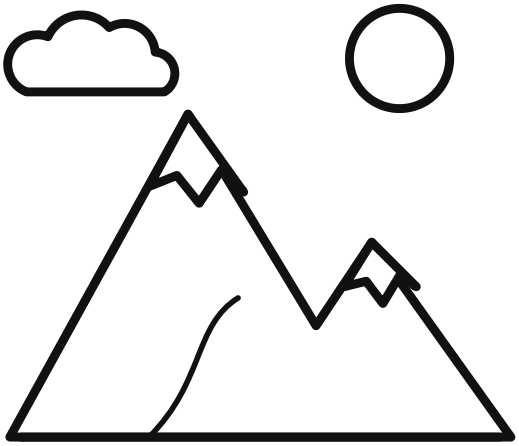
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᑌ ᓗᑌ ᓗᑌ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **u**

Find ᑌ inside ᓇᕐᑌ!



ᑌ IS FOR

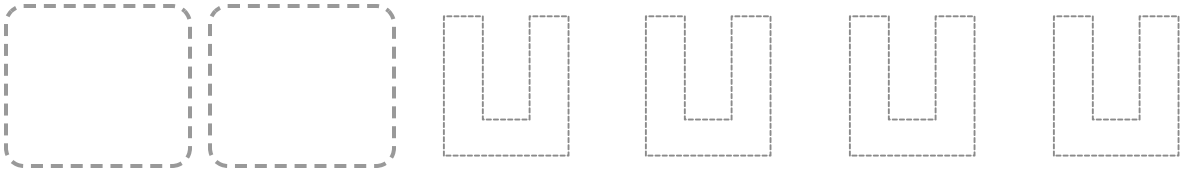
ᓇᕐᑌ

kulu · *koo-loo*

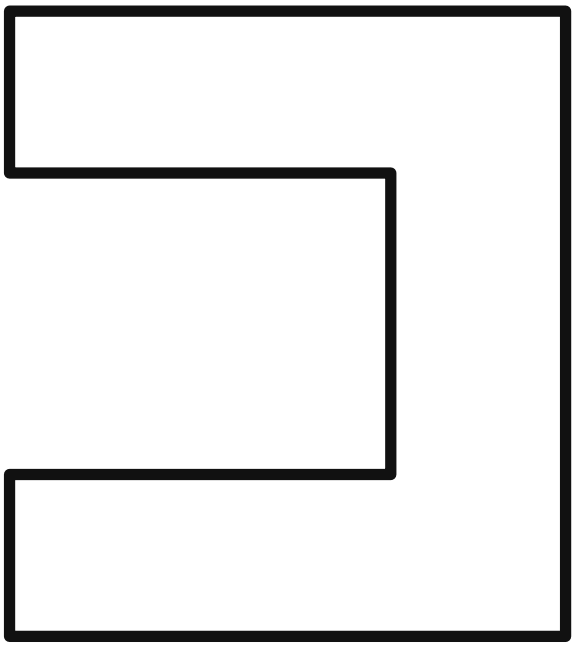
mountain, hill

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᐱᕮᓂ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𞤄𞤵𞤮𞤤𞤮 · TƆGƆ

ɔ

o

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

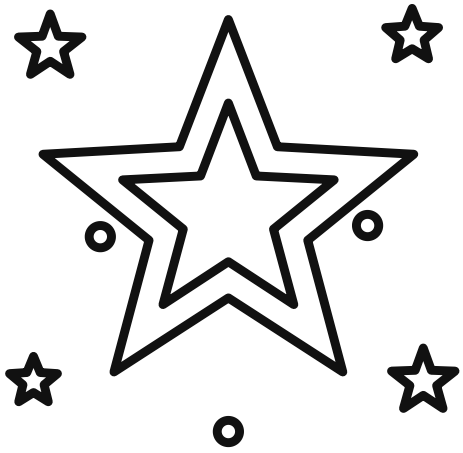
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ɔ ـɔـ ـɔ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **o**

Find ɔ inside 𞤃𞤮𞤤𞤮!



ɔ IS FOR

𞤃𞤮𞤤𞤮

dolo · *doh-loh*

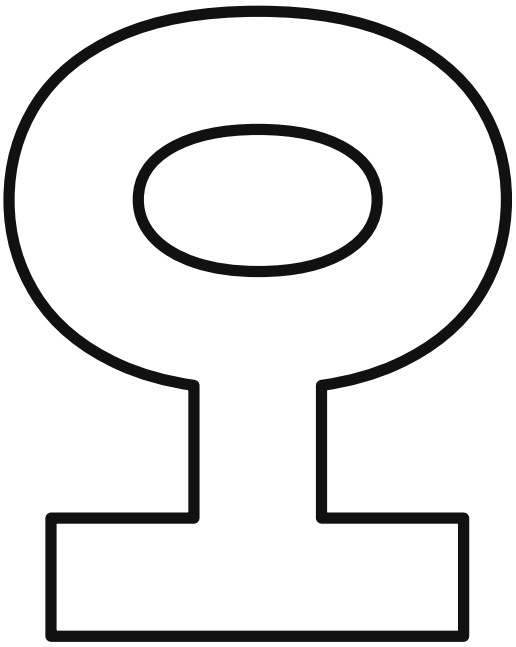
star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤀𞤦𞤫𞤤 · SƐBƐN

ɔ ɔ ɔ ɔ ɔ ɔ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𞤐𞤵𞤲𞤤 · ƬƆGƆ

𞤐

Ɔ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘aw’ as in “saw”

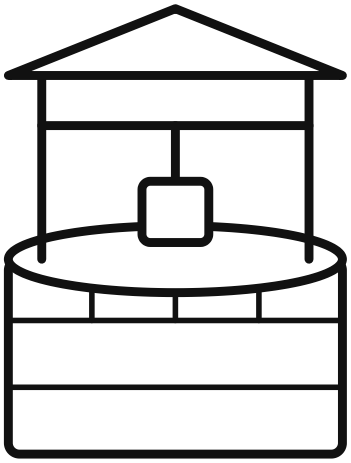
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

𞤐 𞤐 𞤐

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **ɔ**

Find 𞤐 inside 𞤐𞤢𞤐𞤲!



𞤐 IS FOR

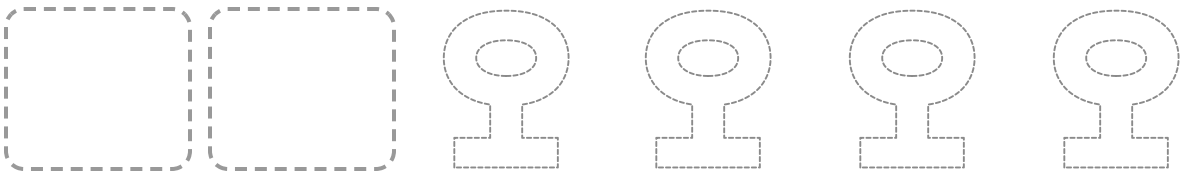
𞤐𞤢𞤐𞤲

kɔlɔn · *kaw-lawn*

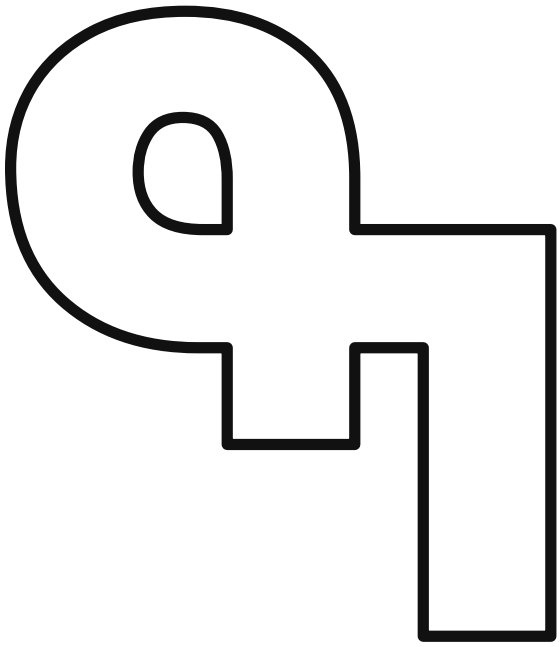
well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤍𞤫𞤤𞤢 · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᵑᐁᵑᓂ · ƬƆGƆ

ᵑᓀ

n

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

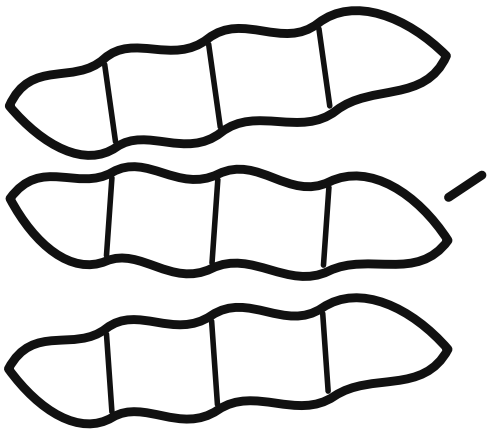
a humming ‘n’ (or ‘ng’) that is a whole syllable by itself

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᵑᓂ ᵑᓂ ᵑᓀ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **n** · also the word for “I”



ᵑᓀ IS FOR

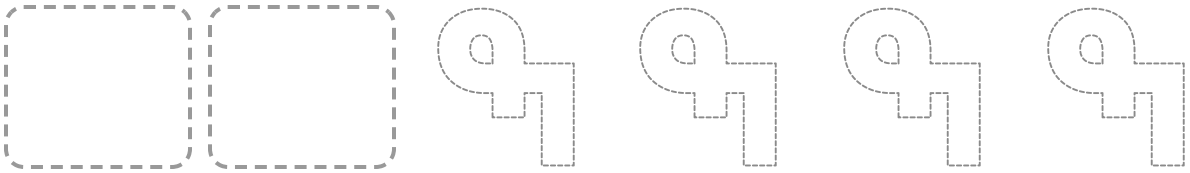
ᖰᐱᑐᓂᑋ

ntomi · *n-toh-mee*

tamarind

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᐱᕮᐱᕀ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

The Consonants ߀ ߁ ߂ ߃

ba · pa · ta · ja … — the 19 consonants

Each consonant is named with the vowel **a**: ߃ is *ba*, ߄ is *ka*, ߅ is *ma*.

Letters hold hands

N’Ko letters **join** along a line, like Arabic letters. Each letter page shows its shape at the start, middle and end of a word.

ߞ߮ߤ = ߞ + ߮ + ߤ + ߄

k + a + l + o = kalo (moon)

One letter, two sounds

ߍ is called *gba*. In Bambara it says ‘g’ as in “go”; in Maninka it says ‘gb’, with both lips closed.

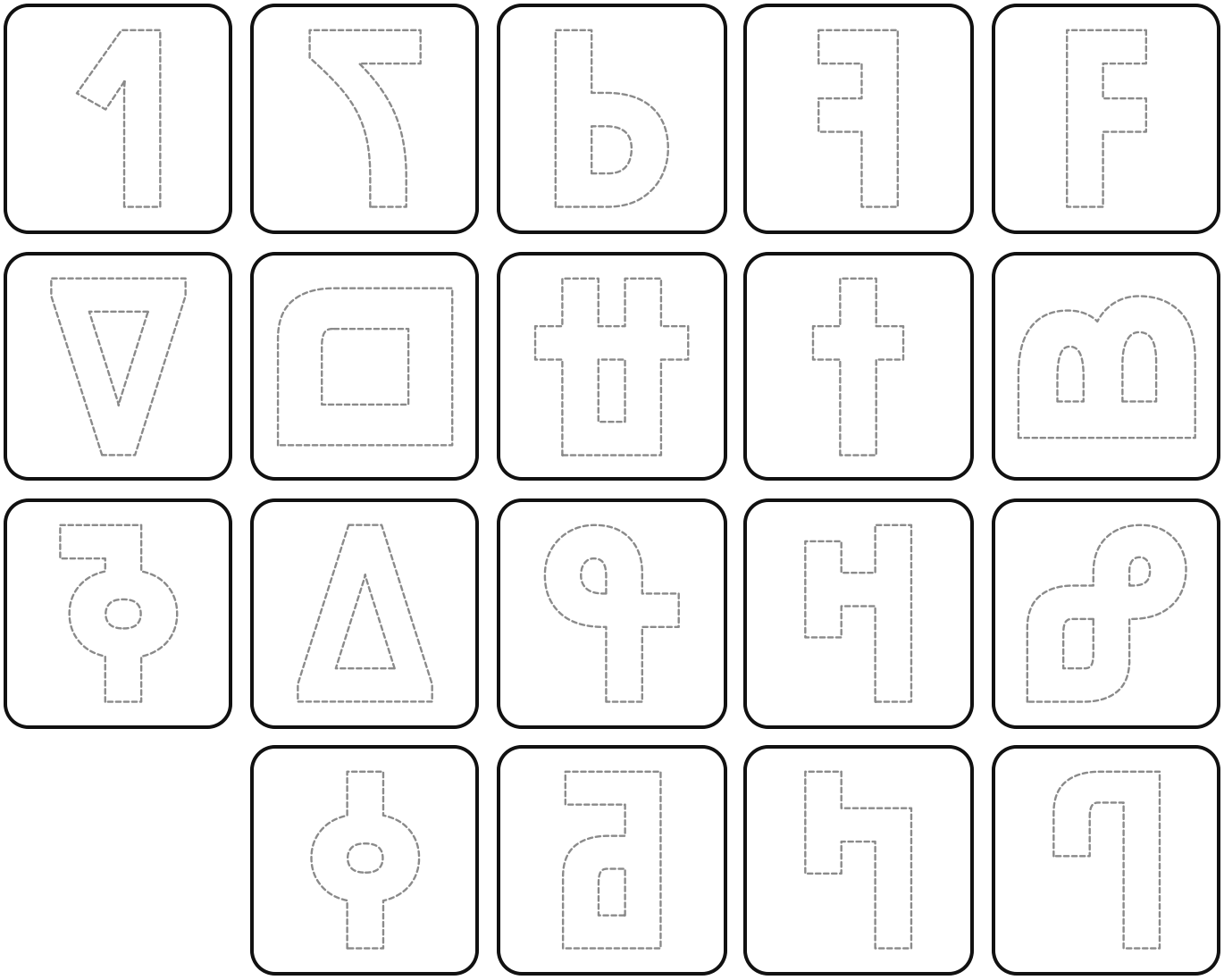
A grown-up shortcut

When two syllables in a row have the same vowel, N’Ko writers often write it only once: ߖ߭ߞ߭ߣ߭߃ can be written ߖ߭ߞ߭ߣ߃. This book writes every vowel, to help you learn.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ʔ b ħ f

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ﭫ

NAME · ᛒᚨᛃᛁ · ƬƆGƆ

ﭫ

ba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

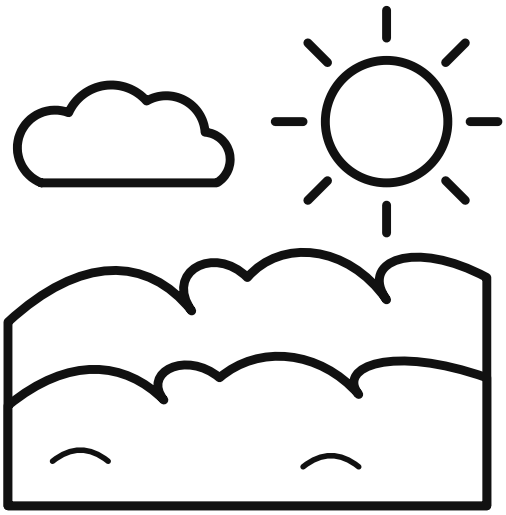
‘b’ as in “ball”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **b**



ﭫ **IS FOR**

ﭫﻴﺠﻲ

baji · *bah-jee*

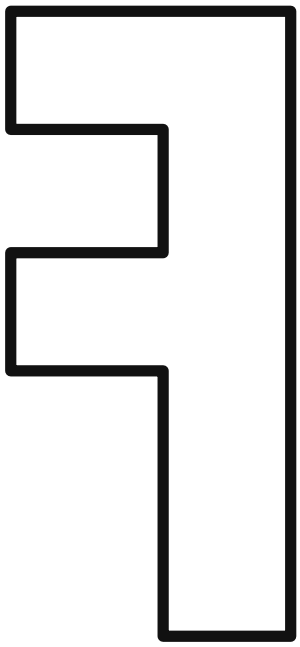
river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᚠᛖᚾᚲᛁᛚ · SƐBƐN

ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᓱᐁᓱᒃ · ƬƆGƆ

ᓭ

pa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

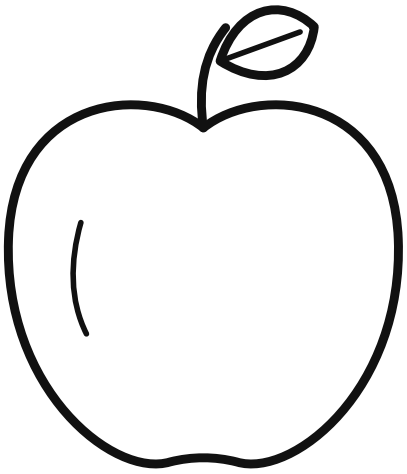
‘p’ as in “pen” — used mostly in borrowed words

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᓬ ᓭᓬ ᓭ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **p**



ᓬ IS FOR

ᓬᐱᓱᓭ

pɔmu · *paw-moo*

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᐯᕮᐱᑘ · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ɓ

NAME · ᑭᐁᑭᒃ · ƬƆGƆ

ɭƀ

ta

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

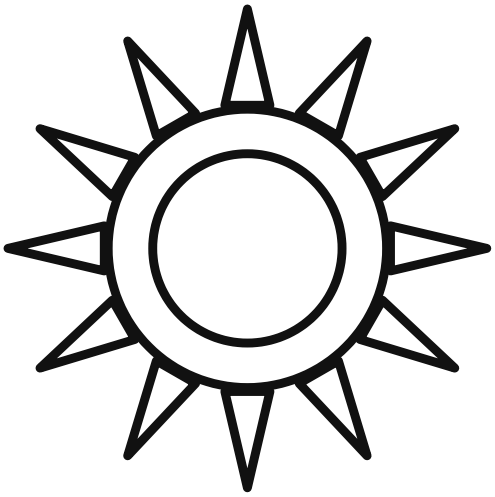
‘t’ as in “top”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ƀ ƀ ƀ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **t**



ɓ IS FOR

ᐅᕫᐊᒃ

tile · *tee-lay*

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᕽᕮᐱᓗ · SƐBƐN

ɓ ɓ ɓ ɓ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ڭ

NAME · ᖘᐯᖘᒃ · ƬƆGƆ

ڭ

ja

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

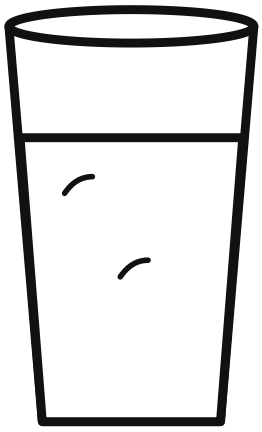
‘j’ as in “jam”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ڭ ـڭـ ـڭ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **j**



ڵ IS FOR

ڵڭ

ji · *jee*

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᙃᕮᓂᐣ · SƐBƐN

ڭ ڭ ڭ ڭ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ᒐ

NAME · ᓯᐢᓯᐦ · ƬƆGƆ

ᒐ

ca

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

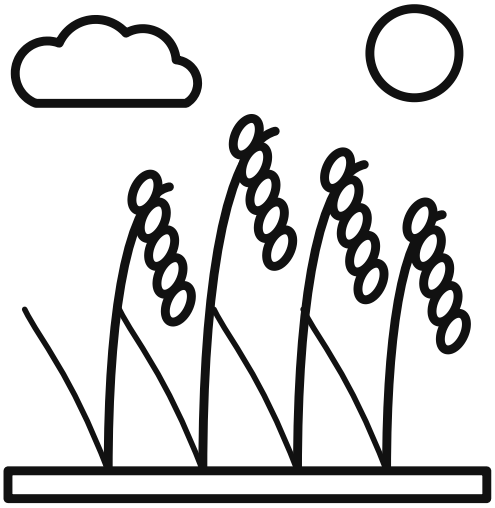
‘ch’ as in “church”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᒐ ᒐ ᒐ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **c**



ᒐ **IS FOR**

ᐱᕼᐩᒐ

cikɛ · *chee-keh*

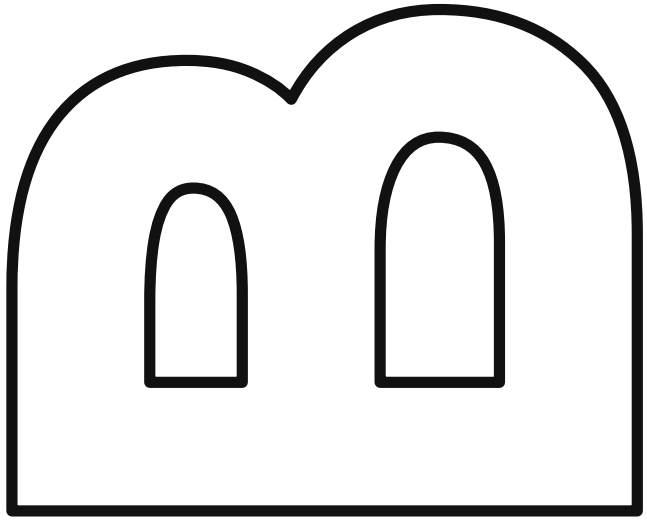
farming, work in the fields

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᓰᕮᐱᕮᑎ · SƐBƐN

ᒐ ᒐ ᒐ ᒐ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𖵎𖵒𖵎𖵆 · ƬƆGƆ

𞤣

da

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

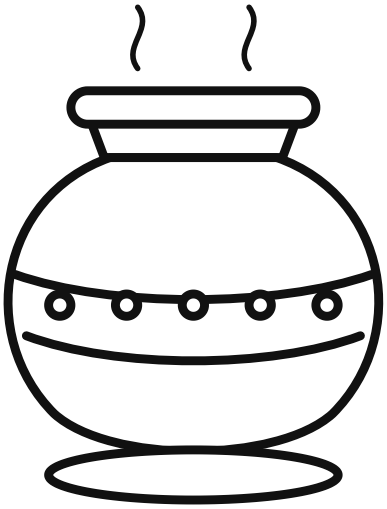
‘d’ as in “dog”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

𞤣 𞤣 𞤣

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **d**



𞤣 IS FOR

𞤣𞤢𞤤𞤣

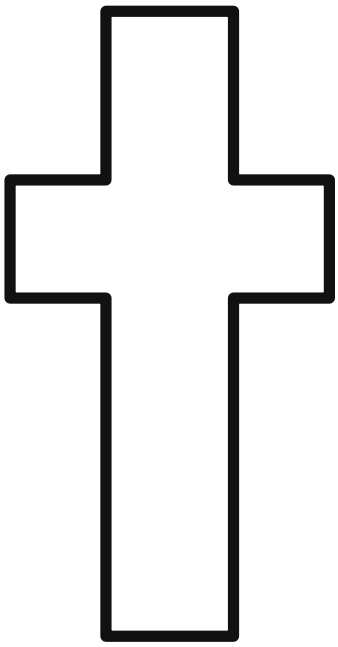
daga · *dah-gah*

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ʌƐʌ□ · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ϘΔϘЬ · ƬƆGƆ

ɻ

ra

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once; never at the start of a Bambara word

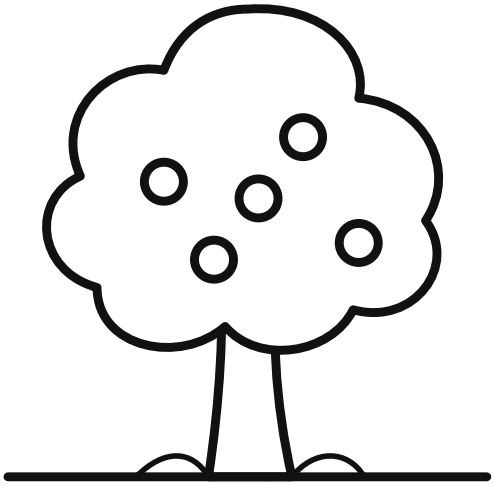
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ŧ ŧ ŧ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **r**

Find ŧ inside ϒŧϒƧ!



ŧ **IS FOR**

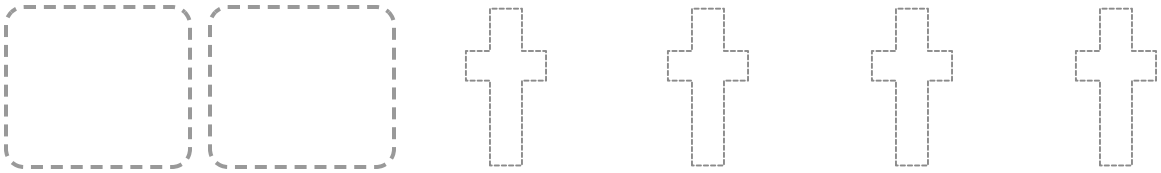
ϒŧϒƧ

jiri · *jee-ree*

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᴧƐᔑ□ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

NAME · 𖵎𖵒𖵑𖵆 · ƬƆGƆ

𞤼𞤼

rra

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

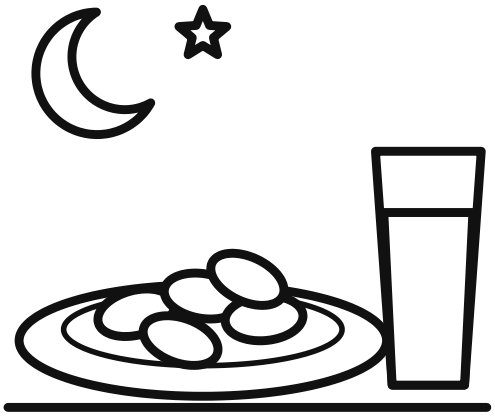
a rolled ‘r’ — let the tongue buzz; used in borrowed words

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

𞤼 𞤼 𞤼

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **rr**



𞤼 IS FOR

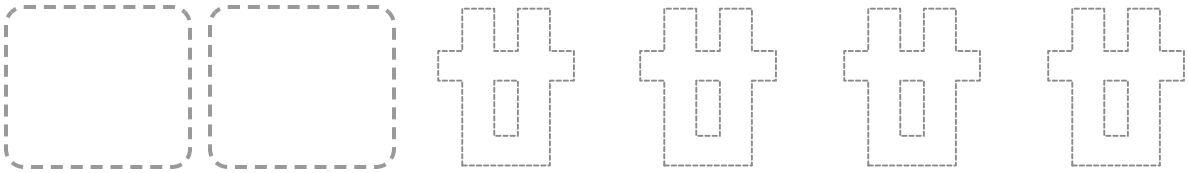
𞤼𞤤𞤢𞤥𞤢𞤼

Ramadan · *rrah-mah-dahn*

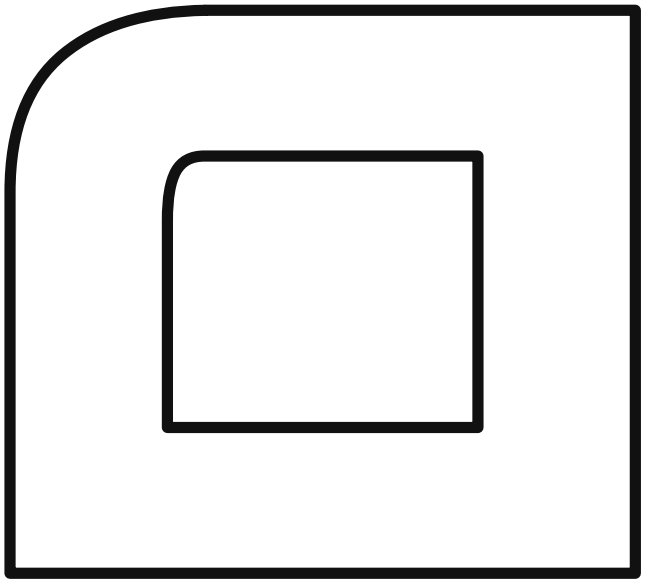
Ramadan, the month of fasting

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᵑƐʌ□ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᵖᵛᵖᵠᵦ · ᵀᑐᏩᑐ

ﺎ

sa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ـﺎ ـﺎـ ﺎ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **s**



ﺎ IS FOR

ﺎﻠﺠﻱ

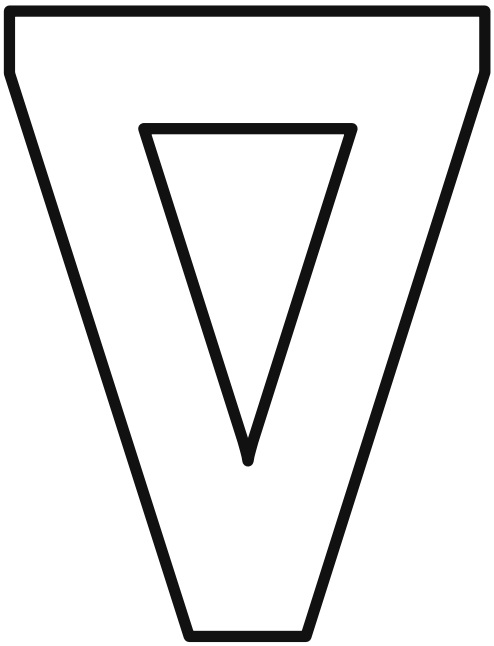
sanji · *sahn-jee*

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᵥᵋᵋᵀ · ᔑᕮᗷᕮᑎ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𞤈𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤦 · TƆGƆ

𞤈𞤢

gba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” in Bambara (‘gb’, said with both lips, in Maninka)

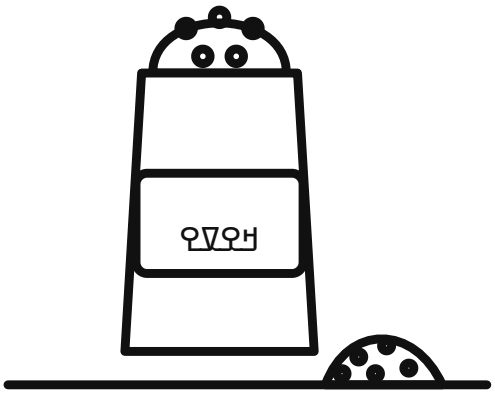
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

𞤈 𞤈𞤤 𞤤

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **g**

Find 𞤈 inside 𞤈𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤦!



𞤈 IS FOR

𞤈𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤦

kɔgɔ · *kaw-gaw*

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤎𞤫𞤱𞤣 · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

NAME · ᖴᐁᖴᒃ · ƬƆGƆ

ﭫ

fa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

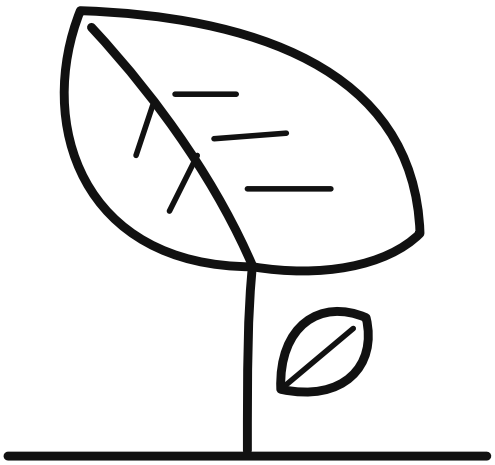
‘f’ as in “fan”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **f**



ﭫ IS FOR

ﺗﻮﺭﺍ

fura · *foo-rah*

leaf (also: medicine)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᙆᕮᐱᒪ · SƐBƐN

ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ ﭫ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ka

NAME · ᵠᵛᵠᵸ · ƬƆGƆ

ka

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **k**



ka IS FOR

kalo

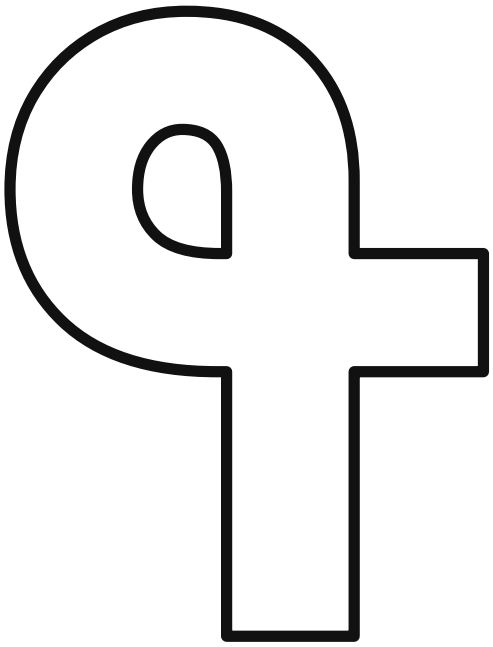
kalo · *kah-loh*

moon (and month)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᵡƐʌᴐ · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᓘᐊᓂᔑ · TƆGƆ

ᓘᓐ

la

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

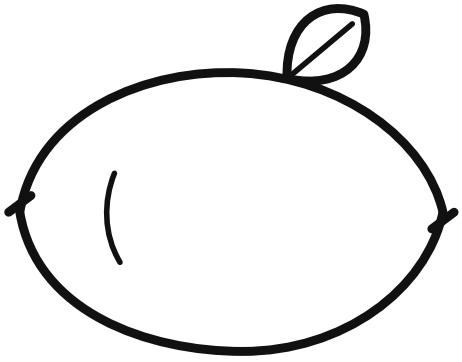
‘l’ as in “lamp”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᓘ ᓘ ᓘ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **l**



ᓘ IS FOR

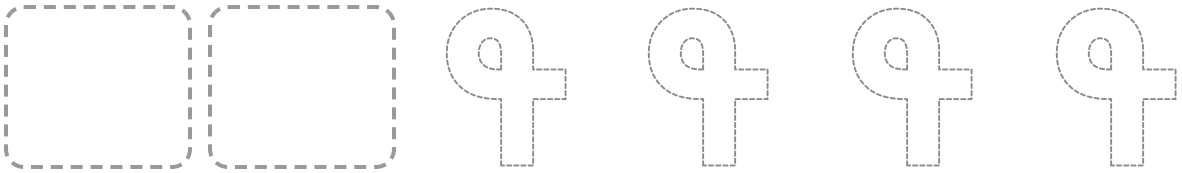
ᓘᓂᔑᓄᓘ

lemuru · *lay-moo-roo*

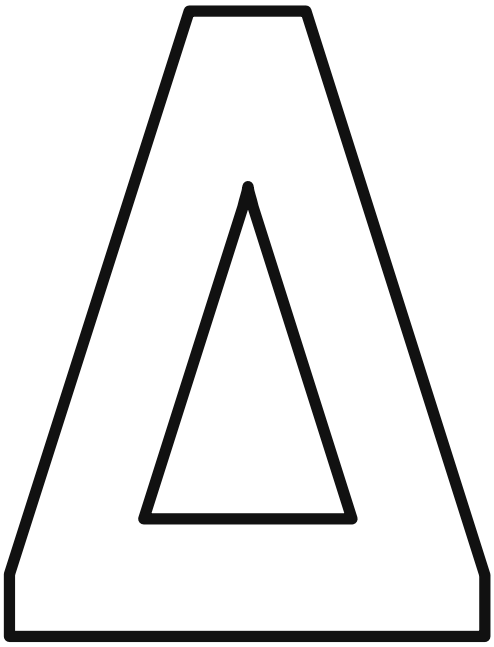
lime, citrus fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᔕᕮᐱᕮᑎ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𖩐𖩗𖩘𖩆 · ƬƆGƆ

ᛚᐃ

ma

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

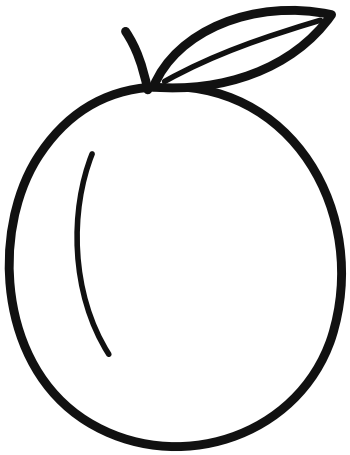
‘m’ as in “moon”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS



start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **m**



ᐃ IS FOR



mangoro · *mahn-goh-roh*

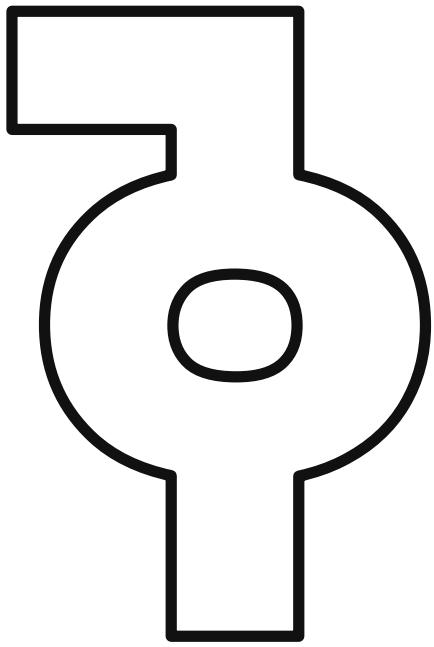
mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᙆᕮᐱᓭ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · 𖵎𖵒𖵑𖵆 · ƬƆGƆ

𖵎

nya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

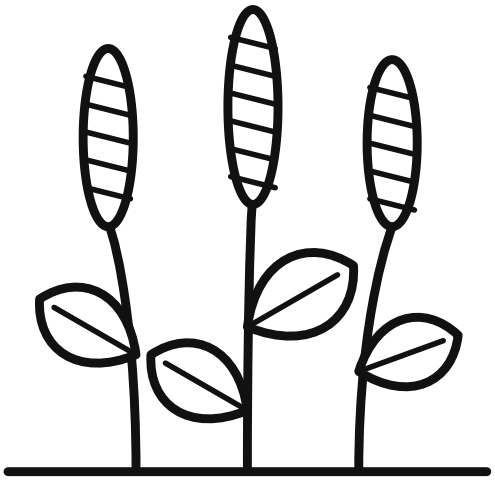
‘ny’ as in “canyon”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

𖵎 𖵎 𖵎

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **ɲ**



𖵎 IS FOR

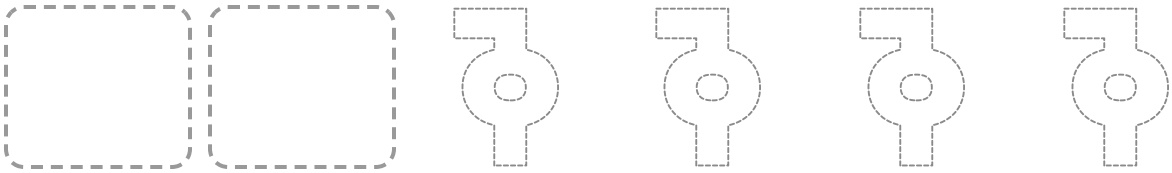
𖵏𖵎

ɲɔ · *nyaw*

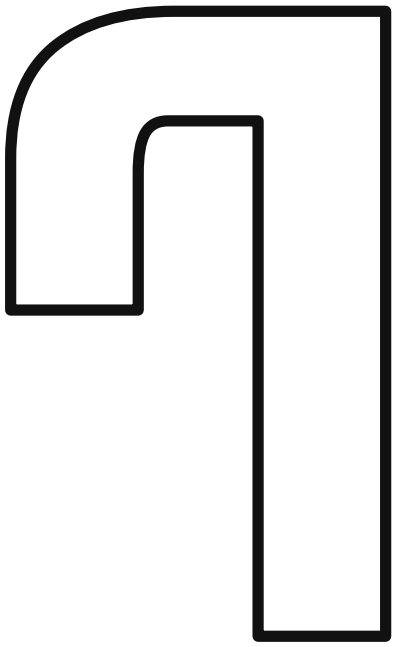
millet

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᴧƐʌ□ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ᵑᐁᵑᑦ · TƆGƆ

ᑎ

na

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ᖁ ᖁ ᖁ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **n**



ᖁ IS FOR

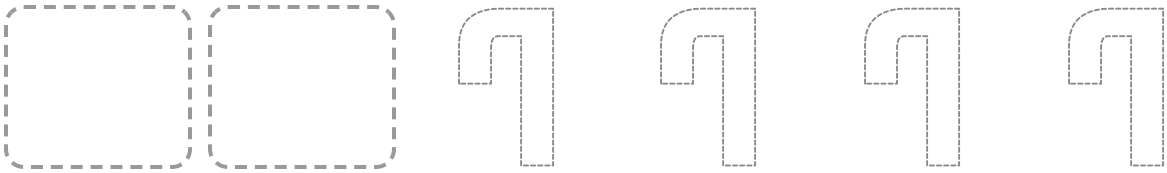
ᑎᖁᑎᖁ

nɔnɔ · *naw-naw*

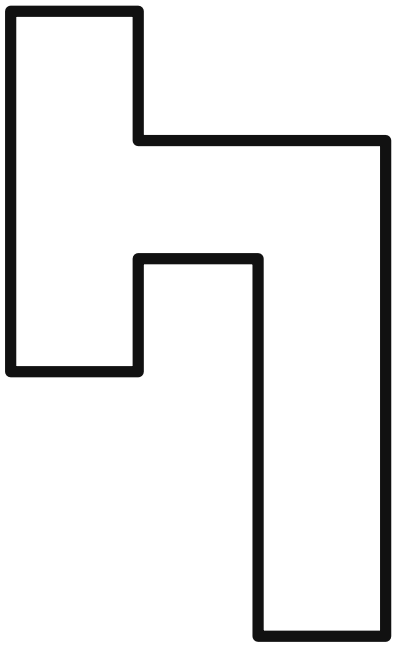
milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᙆᕮᓂᒪ · SƐBƐN



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ⵀⴰ · ƬƆGƆ

ⵀ

ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat” — used mostly in words from Arabic

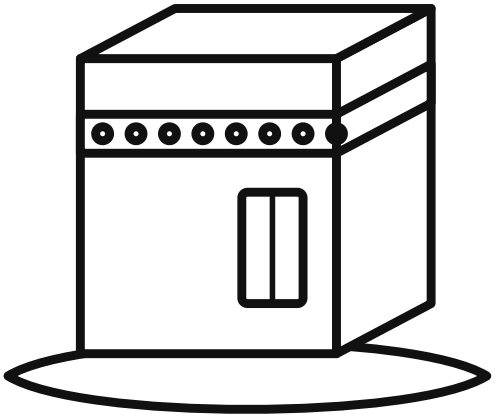
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ⵃ ⵃ ⵃ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **h**

ⵃ IS FOR



ⵢⵣⵢⵃ

hiji · *hee-jee*

Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵏⴻⵛⴱⴻⵏ · SƐBƐN

ⵃ ⵃ ⵃ ⵃ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ⵡ

NAME · ⵡⴰⵡⴰ · ƬƆGƆ

ⵡ

wa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

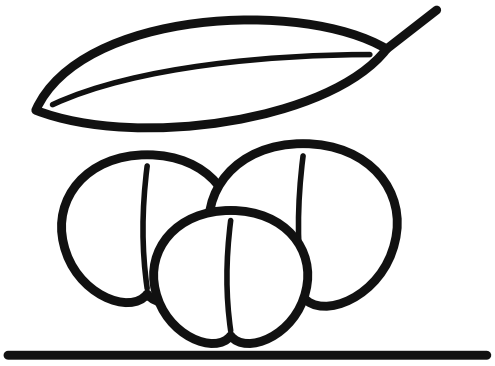
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ⵡ ⵡ ⵡ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **w**

ⵡ IS FOR



ⵡⵓⵔⵓ

woro · *woh-roh*

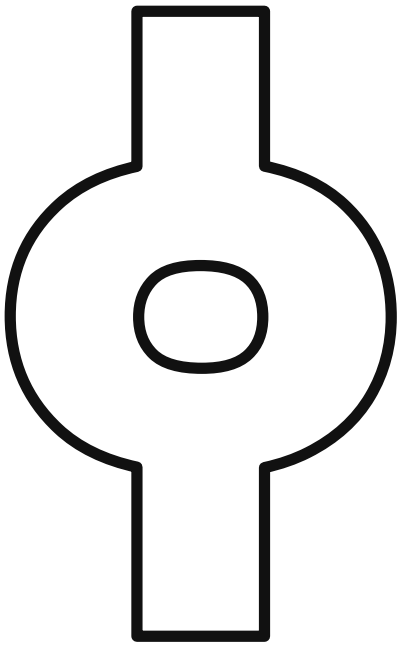
kola nuts

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵜⵉⵎⵙⵉⵔⵉⵏ · SƐBƐN

ⵡ ⵡ ⵡ ⵡ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · ⵢⴰ · ƬƆGƆ

ⵢ

ya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

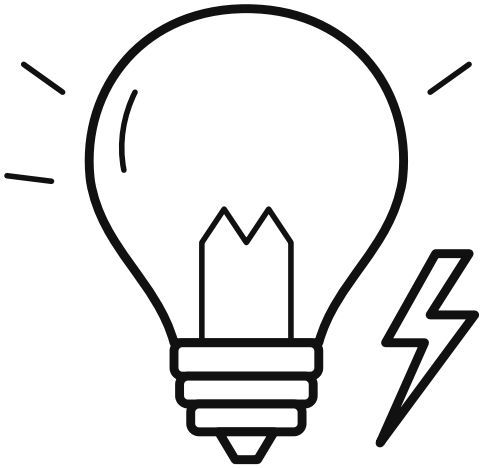
‘y’ as in “yes”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ⵢ ⵢ ⵢ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Latin letter: **y**



ⵢ IS FOR

ⵢⵉⵍⵉⵏ

yeelen · *yay-layn*

light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

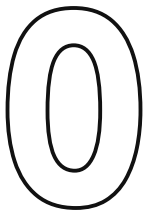
TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵙⵜⵔⴰⵏ · SƐBƐN

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

BONUS

Bambara numbers ߡ߭ßßß *(jate)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Bambara: *sifiri*, *kelen*, *fila*, *saba*...

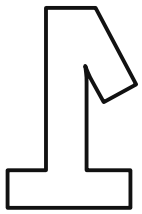


0

ϒtϒ৵ϒ⊓

sifiri

zero

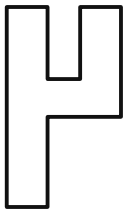


1

ϘϴϴϦ

kelen

one

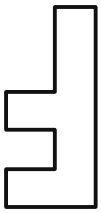


2

ΙϴϒϷ

fila

two

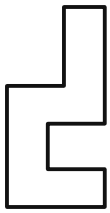


3

ΙΕΙ⊓

saba

three

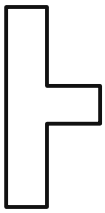


4

ϒ⊐Ω

naani

four

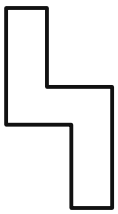


5

ɯtɯ

duuru

five

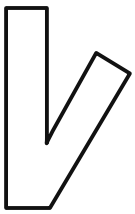


6

ϘtϘϬ

wɔɔrɔ

six



7

ΙϴɯϦϴϬ

wolonwula

seven



8

ϒ⊽ϴ⊓

seegin

eight



9

ϘЬϘ⊐ϘϦ

kɔnɔntɔn

nine

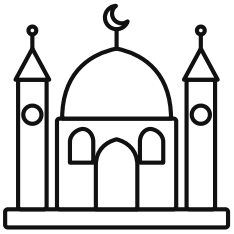
This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LET'S TALK

My first Bambara words 𞤐𞤢𞤪𞤢 𞤂𞤭𞤲𞤳

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

𞤀𞤧𞤲𞤢𞤣𞤭𞤳 𞤥𞤀𞤳𞤭𞤪	*as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
𞤀𞤀𞤳𞤪 𞤀𞤧𞤲𞤢𞤣𞤭𞤳 𞤁𞤢	*wa ah-LAY-koom sah-LAHM* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
… 𞤅𞤮 𞤐𞤅𞤢𞤶 𞤋	*n taw-gaw yay …* **My name is …**
𞤅𞤃 𞤸𞤍 𞤸	*ee nee chay* **Thank you (and also: hello!)**
𞤊𞤢𞤣𞤭𞤧 𞤨𞤀𞤳𞤀𞤪𞤀𞤲	*jah-zah-KAH-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn* **May Allah reward you with good (Bambara: Ala ka i sara)**
𞤨𞤢 · 𞤥𞤲	*bah · fah* **Mother · Father**
𞤒𞤪𞤮𞤬𞤢𞤲𞤳𞤮𞤥𞤲 · 𞤧𞤪𞤢𞤲𞤳𞤮𞤥𞤲	*bah-dayn-keh · bah-dayn-moo-soh* **Brother · Sister**
𞤸𞤢𞤃 · 𞤐𞤋	*ah-waw · ah-yee* **Yes · No**
⁝𞤊𞤲𞤳 𞤊𞤨𞤒𞤀𞤥𞤲 𞤡𞤲 𞤋	*n beh bah-mah-nahn-kahn kah-lahn!* **I am learning Bambara!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

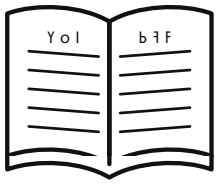
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

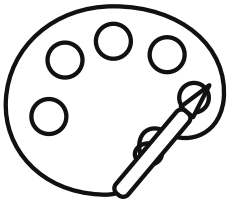
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International).

What's next?
You have met all **27 Bambara letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Bambara, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ⵎⴰⵛⵛⴰⵍⵍⴰⵀ ⵢⴰ ⵅⴰ ⵏⵢⵉ ⴽⵓⵔⵙⵉⴱⵉ!

mah-shah-lah! ah kah nyee koh-seh-beh! — Mashallah! Well done — very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 27 letters of the Bambara alphabet.

_____ _____

Date Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.